

Lala Guluzade

Overview

What is my professional aspiration?

Moving forward, on BA journey I want to:

- Deepen my expertise in specific functional areas to position myself as go-to resource within the Firm
- Explore new industries/functions/geographies to gain valuable knowledge to broaden my knowledge base and continue building my network
- Continue my efforts in coaching and mentoring junior BAs and try to do it in a structured way
- Continue my efforts in Firm building through supporting recruiting process
- Focus on MBA admissions
- Continue active participation in organizing various office wide initiatives (recruiting/coaching-related or social e.g., event organization in Baku office or and etc)

As I Work Toward My Aspiration And Reflect On Previous Development Conversations, How Am I Developing The Relevant Skills And Growing?

Solves Problems

Ministry of Economy (MOE) - Tax-Based Economic Measure (TBEM) study:

- Conducted analysis of 7k+ firms and evaluated their short-, mid-, and long-term response to tariff price changes, identifying key archetypes, enabling predicting a firm's future response to tariff changes
- Further refined methodology to create an independent measure of economic activity, achieving 70-75% official GDP coverage consistently starting from year 2021
- Developed initial version of Input-Output tables , which would allow calculating economic multipliers on yearly basis (typically such tables are published each 5 year)
- Contributed to development of LoP for Phase 2, outlining key activities, potential use cases and required technology stack

PASHA - OHI study:

- Detailed out initiative plan, breaking it down into individual tasks, key milestones and activities
- Structured demographic information of 15+ Assets across 5 industries, consolidating functions and job levels, allowing to generate comparable and granular answers

MOE - Green Zone:

- Performed benchmarking analysis for Green Zones, deep-diving into 3 selected examples
- Performed initial location analysis of potential sites establishing such zone across different dimensions

Winter Event and BA event:

- At both event organized entertainment activities (BA event - created virtual games, Winter event - organized ski classes for 60+ people, which included getting equipment and matching with ski instructors)

Manages Work/Projects

MOE - TBEM study:

- Supported structuring and scoping work to maximize outputs from exploratory analysis of Big Data that was required to be finished in 10 days
- Conducted 10+ onboarding sessions with new client team, after project end, while supporting PASHA OHI study
- Created visuals to communicate complex technology stack needs to non-technical audience

PASHA - OHI study:

- Regularly monitored project progress by creating detailed tracking excel, and providing regular updates to leadership and client teams, raising flags in timely manner
- Organized kick-off individual and group sessions and 1-1 interviews with CEOs of 15+ assets

For both PASHA and MOE projects:

- Working in a setting without EM, owned the workstream as a standalone business analyst, mobilizing clients as needed and ensuring seamless communication between leadership, experts and client

Communicates Effectively

MOE - TBEM study:

- Became go-to person for advisor to the Minister, addressing both context and process-related questions
- Independently facilitated and led meetings with senior government officials, incl. advisors to the Minister, head of the Tax Authority, deputies of State Statistics Committee, and provided inputs at a meeting with the Minister of Economy
- Structured, improved visuals and refined text of a document for Tax Authorities, that was presented to the Minister of Economy and Economic Council of Azerbaijan
- Facilitated several meeting with representatives from various Ministry function, aligning all parties on required action for Phase 2

PASHA - OHI study:

- Independently led meetings with representatives from 15+ assets and facilitated 5+ CEO and CHRO kick-off sessions
- Clearly communicated availability based on TBEM study needs, while being staffed to OHI project

For both PASHA and MOE projects:

- As key contact person with person, timely escalated to leadership any bottlenecks, as well as needs for external expertise

Builds Client Capabilities

MOE - TBEM study:

- Effectively onboarded new client team on the work completed during the project and project plan for Phase 2, enabling client team to independently present findings
- Provided explanation of Python script written during analysis, enabling the client team to perform calculations for subsequent periods with minimal involvement from Mck

Builds Expertise

- Became go-to person locally for questions on understanding GDP, local statistics and OHI survey (supported CST's ongoing efforts)
- Shared past knowledge with MoE FDI study CST, including experts involved, internal resources used, explained how to leverage Firm tools (Economics Platform, Lilli, MVI)
- Shared knowledge gained from TBEM study in developing proposal for Digital Twin and joined Innovation Olympics with project team

Enriches Firm Talent

- Joined recruiting efforts, participating in HR screening interviews
- Continued with coaching of prospective colleagues during their interviews (supported 2 candidates)

Apprentices Others

- Held regular catch-up session with colleagues, who received Interim Check during last committee, sharing my personal learnings and tips and trick on how to act on their development needs
- Actively shared learnings from past Winter Event organization process, to streamline process and ensure we follow Firm Policies (for example, working only with approved vendors, food and drink estimates from last year, issues and their solutions observed in during past year event)
- Continued holding regular catch-ups with junior and newly joint colleagues, sharing my personal experience and addressing their questions

Who are my mentors/sponsors at the Firm?

Sinan K., Murat G., Ugur Cem Y., Rashad M., Maxim U., Simay E., Uluc H., Cem A., Mecit N., Gozde K., Nijat J., Yigit O., Ilbey K.

Looking Ahead**Counsels Clients**

I want to focus on building deeper personal relationships with client team members. Currently I was able to become their go-to person on project-related questions, however I would like to start building relationship expanding beyond direct project work.

Demonstrates Resilience

Since this summer I will start my MBA application process, I need to ensure to be able to balance project needs and studying, also ensuring enough time to reenergize. I became more vocal about needing time-off or support and want to continue doing so.

What support do I need from my mentors/sponsors and the Firm?

I would like support with getting staffed on a project with a larger team, so I can practice coaching junior colleagues in a more structured way. In addition, I would like to try myself in other industries and geographies, to experience working with diverse clients and work environments.

Will this plan give me energy and how can I make it sustainable for me, both personally and professionally?

Proactively scheduling 1-1s with my mentors and Firm Leadership to discussing my development plans and advice on MBA applications. I will continue dedicating necessary time for re-energizing and mental well-being

[Optional] Additional Considerations**What are the top 3 topics, if any, I would like to discuss with my DGL?**

What should I focus on going further as senior BA